

Monasteries

Monasteries were the centers of religious life in Tibet. Parents sent their young sons, often between the ages of six and twelve, to the monasteries. There, they learned from teachers, called lamas, and became monks. Around the time Lhamo was born, more than half of Tibetan boys and men were monks.

At the monasteries, boys had to shave their heads and wear red and yellow robes. They studied sacred Buddhist books and learned to chant and pray. They also learned how to meditate—to focus quietly in their minds. When students were ready, they took vows to become monks,